



A D&D 5E adventure for 9th-11th level characters
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ADVENTURE SUMMARY

The adventuring party finds themselves locked in a dungeon by a former foe with a grudge. Inspired by the Saw series, the adventurers will need to solve multiple sadistic traps and recover five skeleton keys needed to escape.

NOTE TO THE DM

This adventure focuses on revenge and features a pre-made villain (an orc named Jok-Rammer) but it is highly suggested you swap him out for an NPC from your own adventure if you're currently running a campaign. Odds are your party has unknowingly created several supervillains in their time. If you customize the villain you will need to alter the corpse in the middle of the room plus the monologue before the final battle.

This adventure takes place in one action-packed dungeon so please read ahead and familiarize yourself with the traps & encounters.

The Five Skeleton Key locations: The Corpse, Weapon's Chest, Razor Box, Hobgoblin Cage, Needle Pit.

Five 9th level characters will find the dungeon to be a struggle whereas 11th level characters will have an easier time. Adjust accordingly.

Sentences in italics are narration or dialogue.

Sentences in red are skill checks.

Encounters are in purple.

ENVIRONMENTAL TRAPS

The dungeon has built-in traps which the players might come across at any time.

MAGIC CIRCLES

There are two visible magic circles in the dungeon. **Arcana DC 15** will fill in magic users on what secrets the circles hold.

The Circle of Death is a sadistic yet rudimentary spell in the middle of the dungeon that requires a **Wisdom Save DC 14** or the creature inside the circle takes

5d6 necrotic damage. Prepare for players to use this circle in combat against enemy creatures.

The Summoning Circle in the northeast is used in the finale of the adventure when the fifth and final skeleton key is inserted into the iron door. The spiritual form of Jok-Rammer appears in the circle alongside his undead orc minions.

BLOWGUN TRAP

The two torches on the western wall have blowguns rigged at their base. The trap is activated when a creature walks on a square lined up with a torch. This also helps explain why the pit of blades is full of needle-like darts! **A Dexterity Saving Throw DC 13 is required to avoid the blowgun or take 1d8 piercing damage.**

POISONED PARTY

The party has been poisoned by their captor and will suffer **1d12 poison damage every 10 minutes upon failure of a Constitution Saving throw DC 13.** Once the antidote in the ale barrels in the northwest is consumed the poison stops.

THE CORPSE (PIGSAW)

The corpse in the middle of the dungeon is our villain, Jok-Rammer (or your own campaign-related villain.) His mortal body is dead from blood loss, but his spirit lives on in the walls of this personal hell he's created for the people he believes responsible for his pain, suffering, and disfigurement.

In Jok-Rammer's hand is a bonesaw (a +1 dagger).

ADVENTURE

The party will awaken in a dark room, poisoned and chained up without weapons. However many players there are, there are that many weapon chests +1 to the west. The extra chest has their weapons and gear. The other chests are actually all mimics!

The players will likely navigate counterclockwise since their weapons are to the west.

DUNGEON INTRO (POISON, SHACKLES, AND JOK-RAMMER)

You awaken in a large dimly lit dungeon, a shackle around your ankle. You've been chained to a wall, a five foot gap between you and your other party members. The ground is cold and covered in brown dried up blood. Your armor remains but your weapons are gone. Each of you have a small prick on your arm and there are strange glyphs etched into the walls of this bone-filled dungeon.

On the opposite end of the dungeon, to the north, is a sealed iron door. A row of wooden chests line the western wall, two lit torches hanging above them.

To the southeast are large cages hanging from rusty chains and just to the east of you is a 15 foot wide pit.

Lastly, teen feet in front of you is a naked dead humanoid, covered in blood with a mask made from rotting pig flesh. The creature has several darts embedded in his chest, while in his outstretched hand is a key carved from bone.

Your vision blurs a bit as you feel a burning pain coursing through your body.

Constitution Saving Throw DC 13: Poison

Failures result in 1d12 poison damage. Repeat saving throws every 10 minutes until they take the antidote in the northwest ale barrels.

JOK-RAMMER'S MONOLOGUE

The glyphs on the dungeon walls glow ever so slightly, a faint green light cutting through the darkness. A gravelly voice speaks through the runes.

"Rise and shine, heroes. For so long you've delved dungeons just like this, killing creatures with swords, spells, and bows. It's only fitting this is where you meet your end. Your weapons which you value so much are in the chest just to the west, but first you'll need to escape your chains. It's time to see if you're as clever and strong as you think you are. It's time to play a game."

The glow from the glyphs fade.

Athletics Roll: Breaking Shackles

DC 17: You succeed in breaking the chain.

Arcana\History Roll: Wall Glyphs

DC 22: The glyphs can hold previously recorded messages.

DC 15: These are communication glyphs, often used by someone not on the premises.

DC 10: Glyphs can sometimes be used for magical purposes!

THE CHESTS (MIMIC ENCOUNTER)

However many players there are, there are that many chests +1. One wooden chest has their gear, the rest are mimics who attack the adventurers. The mimics are triggered when the players open any of the chests.

Old wooden storage chests line the western wall. Their locks are clasped and secure.

Perception Roll: The Chests (Mimics)

DC 22: You see one of the chests is breathing. This is no chest. It's a mimic.

DC 20: Some of the chests are stained in dried blood.

DC 12: The wooden chests are standard weapon chests.

Encounter: Mimics

This should be a relatively easy encounter for the party if they have their weapons, which they'll likely retrieve during the battle.

Monsters: Mimics (MM page 220).

Loot in Chest: Their weapons, a Skeleton Key, 200 gold, 2 Greater Healing Potions, a Ring of Identify (one use of Identify spell per long rest), Boots of Striding and Springing (Basic Rules, page 156), and a glittery helmet (Magic Helm Trap)

MAGICAL HELM TRAP

When a player puts on the glittery magical helm it triggers the trap. The helmet has 5hp, is immune to non-magical attacks, but appropriate **Arcana and Sleight of Hand checks (DC 15)** will free them.

The helmet slowly tightens and every 15 seconds the wearer must make a **Strength Saving Throw DC 17** or take 1d8 bludgeoning damage, half on successful saves.

The helmet fits like a glove, a perfect fit, almost as if it was made for you. Then it gets a bit tight. Then tighter. You feel pain as the helmet slowly begins crushing your skull while the visor on the helm slides down covering your whole face.

TAVERN TABLES (POISON ANTIDOTE)

The party must drink three gallons of ale each to neutralize the poison inside them. This might be a good time to have the players roll a constitution save against poison.

There are old busted up tavern tables and chairs with several dusty web-covered mugs. Next to the tables are ale barrels.

The runes on the walls glow as the gravelly voice speaks:

“By now you’ve felt the effects of the poison inside you. To counter this you must take in another poison, one you’ve had no problem drinking down again and again during your adventures. The antidote is in the ale next to you. But by my calculations you’ll need to drink three gallons each, at least.

Charisma Saving Throw: Overdrinking Ale

DC 15: You’re buzzed but this isn’t your first rodeo.

DC Under 15: The ale is stronger than expected and you’re definitely a bit wobbly (Disadvantage on Initiative Rolls the rest of the dungeon.)

THE RAZOR BOX

A skeleton key is hidden in an indestructible clear box on a five foot pedestal. The key is tethered by a small link chain and the players must find a way to reach in to get the key. The opening consists of four bladed flaps that will cut the player if they pull their arm back.

Pulling the key out requires an **Athletics DC 14** as well as a **Sleight of Hand DC 16** to avoid 2d6 slashing damage on the way out.

Next to the tavern tables is a five foot pedestal with a long clear box upon it. The box is about two feet long and in the back is a Skeleton Key tethered by a link of chain.

The clear box has two openings consisting of four collapsing blades. Sticking your hand in will be easy, getting it out is a different story.

THE IRON DOOR

The only exit is a magically sealed door which has five jagged keyholes. The Skeleton Keys for the lock do NOT open the door, they instead trigger the Summoning Circle and bring on the final boss, Jok-Rammer!

This sealed iron door radiates a dark energy and has five jagged keyholes but no handle or knob.

PIT OF BLADES

A Skeleton Key is tethered to the bottom of a 15 foot pit full of blades! Entering and exiting the pit results in 1d12 piercing damage.

The pit is fifteen feet deep and full of needle-sharp darts, rusty razor blades, and other bladed objects.

A perception\investigation DC 12 reveals a Skeleton Key is trapped in the middle of the blades about ten feet down.

TORTURE CAGES (GOBLIN DEVASTATORS & RUST MONSTERS)

There are Hobgoblin remains in the cages and one mangled corpse on the table. There is a Skeleton Key in one of the cages and when the players interact with the cage, goblins, or key, it will trigger the villainous monologue and encounter.

After the first round of combat, the Rust Monsters emerge from their nest (the busted hole in the northeast wall). Rust Monsters can destroy non-magical weapons when they make contact! You might need to tweak the monologue based on party composition.

A mangled hobgoblin's body is smeared on a torture rack. Above him are hanging cages, the skeletal remains of hobgoblins lining the bases. The glyphs on the walls glow.

"The sight of dead goblins is nothing new to you. Throughout your journey you've cut down countless goblins without a thought of their wives, husbands, or children. There's a famous saying in Faerun: The only good goblin is a dead goblin. I agree."

There is a rustling from inside each of the hanging cages. The goblin bones begin snapping together before their fully reformed bodies grab their corroded weapons and burst free from their cages. Roll for initiative.

Encounter: Hobgoblin Devastators & Rust Monsters

The Goblins will be reanimated and use Hobgoblin Devastator statistics. After the first round, the Rust Monsters emerge.

***Rust Monsters:** Skittering out of the busted hole in the northeast is a beast the size of a baby hippo. It has two long antennae on its head, a hard shell, and sharp fangs. Then another one emerges from the hiding spot. Their beady eyes look at you, then to your weapons. The glyphs glow once more.*

“For so long you’ve relied on your weapons to save you. Your swords and arrows have taken countless lives, but how good is a fighter without his broadsword? How threatening is a rogue without his blade?”

Nature Roll: Rust Monsters

DC 18: The corrosion effect does not work on magical weapons.

DC 15: Rust monsters can corrode metal weapons upon contact.

DC10: These are rust monsters!

Monsters: 4 Hobgoblin Devastators (Volo’s Guide page 161), 2 Rust Monsters (MM page 262)

Loot: Skeleton Key, another antidote barrel in the Rust Monster nest.

JOK-RAMMER (BOSS ENCOUNTER)

The villain responsible for this dungeon is an Orc named Jok-Rammer whom the party almost killed during one of their many skirmishes against orcs. The party will not remember this orc, which is his point. The corpse with the pig mask in the middle of the dungeon is Jok-Rammer’s mortal body, but his essence and magic lives in these walls.

When the final key is inserted into the iron door, Jok-Rammer’s spirit will manifest in the Summoning Circle, flanked by four undead orc minions.

The Summoning Circle crackles with a dark energy before bursting into flames, smoke filling this side of the dungeon. Through the smoke you see standing in the

summoning circle, a ghostly version of the orc corpse in the center of the dungeon, he is fully healed, his face free of cuts and scars.

As the smoke dissipates you see he is flanked by four undead orc warriors, their flesh sliding off the bone.

“Remember me?”

History Roll: Remembering Jok-Rammer

DC 18: You think you fought this guy and his cronies outside a cave somewhere a while back.

“To you I was just another Orc in your way. You slaughtered my friends, shooting us with arrows, stabbing us with your blades, even conjuring up magic spells to destroy us. You thought us all dead, but my rage would not let me perish. I came across a pig farmer and his wife who had just enough medicine to save me. I tried to remedy my disfigurement by making a mask from their faces but I learned human flesh doesn’t hold up as well as a pig’s.”

“I went to our shamans who taught me everything necessary to get my revenge. You might have had a chance against my mortal form, but now there is no surviving this dungeon. No chance of surviving Jok-Rammer!”

Encounter: Jok-Rammer & Orcs

The party faces off against Jok-Rammer and four undead orc minions. This should be a tough final fight. Utilize Jok-Rammer’s spell list.

Monsters: Jok-Rammer (Stat block below), 4 Orcs (MM page 246)

Loot: Pig Mask (+1 Intimidation) worth 1,250gp to the right collector, 3 vials of ectoplasm worth 250gp each.

JOK-RAMMER

Medium humanoid (orc), chaotic evil

Armor Class 14 (hide armor)

Hit Points 60 (8d8 + 24)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)

Skills Arcana +3, Intimidation +3

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages Common, Orc

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Pig Face. Enemies within 30 feet must make a successful wisdom saving throw or suffer the effects of the Fear spell.

Spellcasting. Jok-Rammer is a 10th-level spellcaster. His spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). Jok-Rammer has the following wizard spells prepared:

Spells. Cantrips (at will): Mage hand, Poison spray, Chill touch, Message

1st level (4 slots): Ray of sickness, Magic missile, Shield, Sleep

2nd level (3 slots): Invisibility, Alter self, Suggestion

3rd level (3 slots): Fly, Counterspell

4th level (3 slots): Blight, Stoneskin

5th level (2 slots): Dominate person

ACTIONS

Bonesaw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 10 (1d12 + 4) slashing damage + 1d6 poison damage.

Poisoned Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. Hit: 11 (1d6 + 3 plus 1d8) piercing damage + 3d6 poison damage, or 12 (2d8 + 3) piercing damage + 3d6 poison damage if used with two hands to make a melee attack.

ESCAPING THE DUNGEON

After vanquishing Jok-Rammer, the iron door opens revealing a stairway. Upstairs they find themselves in one of the shadier taverns in town (use an existing campaign tavern if possible).

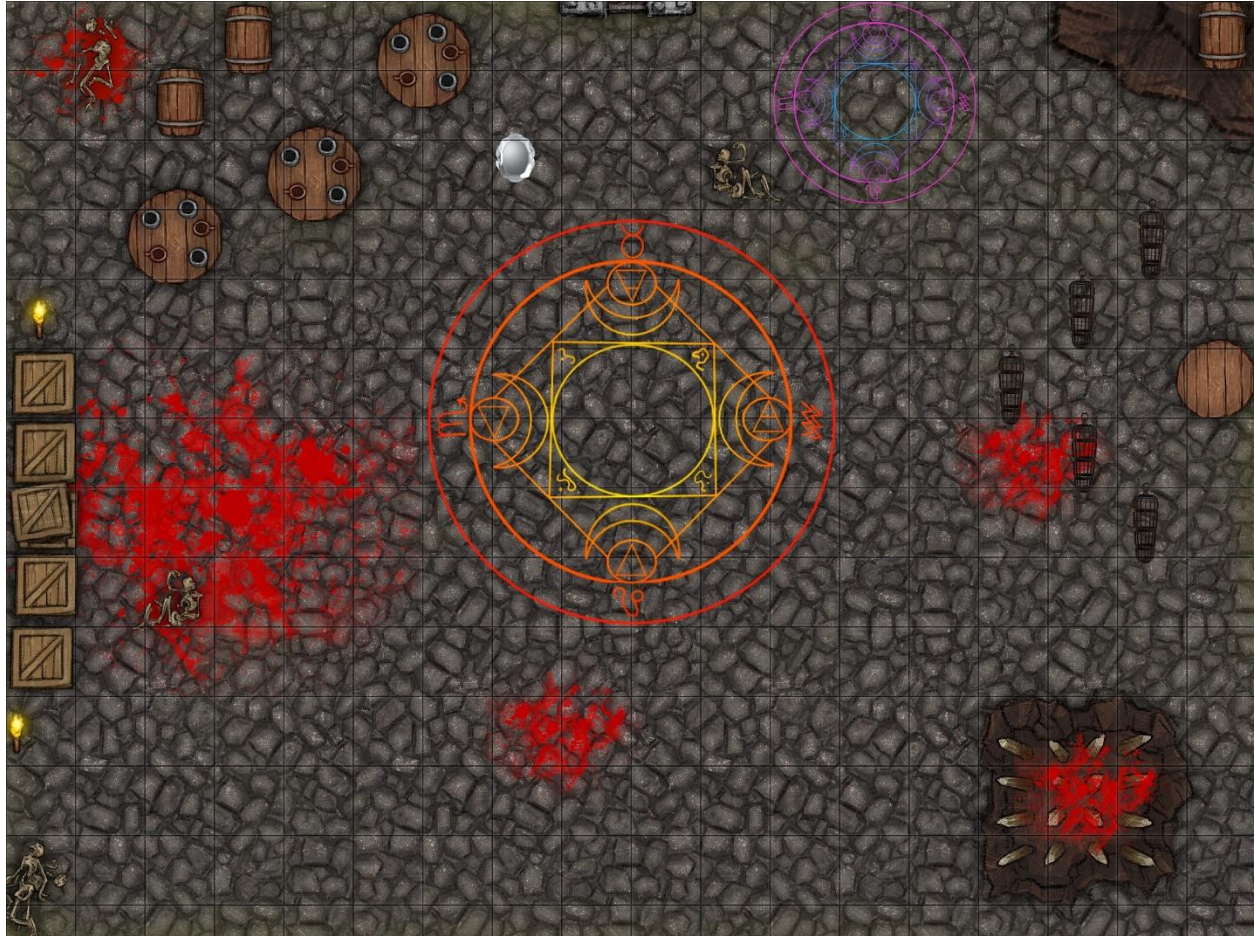
As Jok-Rammer's spirit fades, you hear a click from the Iron Door. The door slides open revealing a stairwell up to freedom.

CONTINUING FROM HERE

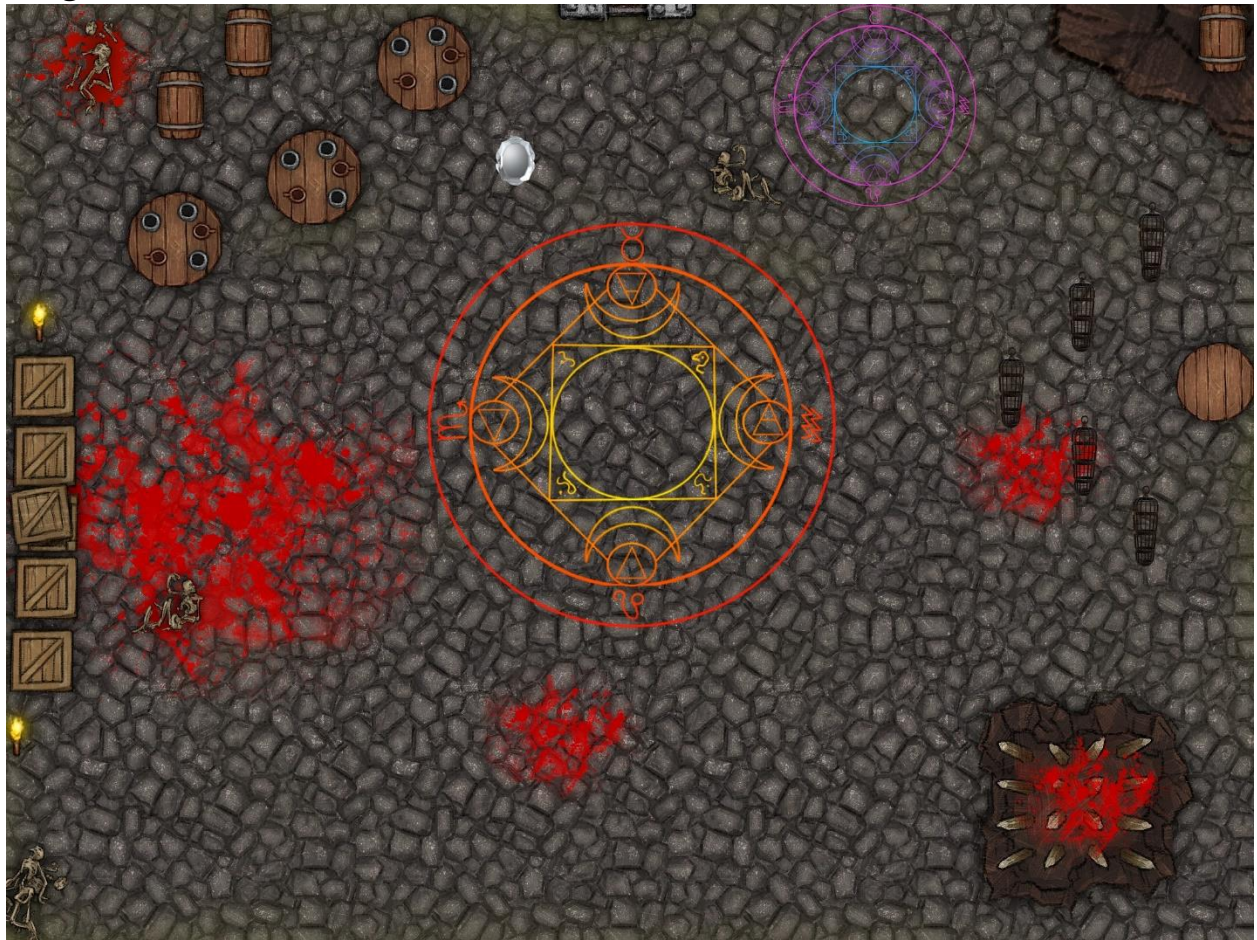
Use the location of this dungeon to segue into your next adventure. Maybe it's the next town over or if the case calls for it, across the entire continent!

MAP

Here's a little guide on how to put your map together.



No grid



Thank you for playing.

If you enjoyed this adventure, please leave a review and check out more at DMSGuild.com!



PIGSLAW



DALE ZAWADA